

Python Basics

School of Finance, Nankai University

Spring term 2025/2026

Overview

Students enrolled to Python Basics are compulsory to complete the following final coursework assessment as a part of fulfilment. The coursework contributes **60%** toward the overall mark for the module.

Group Allocation

Each group should include no more than three group members.

Assignment Deadline

Friday 17 July 2026

Submission Requirement

All groups should **ONLY** submit **Python codes** (in one python coding file) and **written report** (PDF format) before the deadline. You only need to submit the electronic version through **Feishu** as required by lecturer and teaching assistant. Late submissions will be **penalized**.

Cover Sheet:

You should include your group details on the first page of your report. Following details should be included: ***Full names and student IDs of group members***

Style Requirement

Reports written in either **English** or **Chinese** are acceptable. No specific requirements for the format of your report (e.g., font size). But the main text should be **consistently formatted** (i.e., avoiding modifying the font, size and colour). Formal tables and graphs are **preferred** to screenshots when presenting empirical results.

Word limit

No more than 2000 words

Coursework Assignment

You should read Dyck, Lins, Roth and Wagner (2019, JFE) and Skinner (2008, JFE), and then complete following tasks:

1. Based on the materials covered in the 'ESG and IO' project, test the relation between institutional ownership and RepRisk environmental (E), social (S) and governance (G) incidents **separately** and discuss your regression results. [30 marks]
2. Based on Skinner (2008, JFE), briefly introduce the corporate payout policy and the motivation of firms to use dividends and repurchase. [10 marks]
3. Following the methodology of Skinner (2008, JFE), **replicate and summarize** their main results using the same sample period (1970-2005). The main results should include: Figure 1, Figure 2 and Figure 3; Table 1 and Table 2. The regression results of Table 3 are optional. [30 marks]
4. **Update** the analysis of Task 3 to the current period (i.e., 2006-2025) using the same data sources and methodology. Then compare the results with original paper and discuss the evolution of corporate payout policies over the last two decades. [30 marks]

Other important notes:

1. ZERO TOLERANCE for data fabrication.
2. DO NOT plagiarize the original text.
3. DO NOT submit the data files.
4. Make sure that you include all the results in your report such as tables and graphs.
DO NOT submit the code but without including the results in your report.
5. Each group needs to submit the coursework ONLY once.

Good Luck!